JAMES HARTLEY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Forward Deployed Engineer with 14 years of experience building and maintaining infrastructure at customer sites and remote locations. I thrive in high-pressure environments where systems need to work reliably with minimal support infrastructure. My background spans cloud migrations, on-premises deployments, and hybrid architectures across financial services and government sectors. I focus on solving real operational problems and mentoring teams to handle complex deployments independently.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer (Staff)

Stratix Systems Ltd

https://stratix-systems.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led deployment operations for enterprise clients across EMEA region, managing end-to-end infrastructure buildouts in restricted environments with limited connectivity and resource constraints. Architected and implemented resilient monitoring solutions that reduced mean time to resolution by 62% across 40+ customer sites. Established deployment frameworks and runbooks that enabled junior engineers to execute complex infrastructure changes with confidence, reducing deployment duration by 35%. Mentored a team of five deployment engineers, conducting technical reviews and knowledge transfer sessions on containerization, infrastructure-as-code practices, and incident response procedures.

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

Clearwater Tech plc

https://www.clearwatertech.com

London, United Kingdom

June 2016 - February 2021

Deployed and maintained hybrid cloud infrastructure for financial services clients requiring strict compliance with regulatory frameworks including PCI-DSS and SOC 2. Designed automated provisioning pipelines using Terraform and Ansible that reduced manual deployment time from 8 hours to 45 minutes across 15+ environments. Implemented comprehensive logging and alerting infrastructure using ELK stack and Prometheus, establishing observability standards adopted across 12 customer accounts. Led incident response for critical production outages, achieving 99.97% uptime SLA across managed services portfolio.

Infrastructure Technician

Nexus Solutions Ltd

https://nexus-solutions.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

September 2010 - May 2016

Deployed and configured physical and virtual infrastructure for enterprise clients transitioning from legacy on-premises systems to modern cloud architectures. Built and validated server environments running Windows

Server and Linux, ensuring compatibility with customer applications and security requirements. Managed network connectivity and firewall configurations for customer sites, coordinating with telecommunications providers to establish redundant connections. Provided on-site technical support during critical deployments and migrations, troubleshooting hardware issues and optimizing system performance in live production environments.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2006 - 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and Deployment: Terraform, Ansible, AWS, Azure, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, VMware, Hyper-V, KVM

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, BGP, OSPF, firewall configuration, load balancing, VPN, SD-WAN

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic, Splunk

Operating Systems: Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, Debian), Windows Server, FreeBSD

Scripting and Automation: Python, Bash, PowerShell, Go

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, MongoDB, Redis

Compliance and Security: PCI-DSS, SOC 2, ISO 27001, HIPAA, zero-trust architecture

Version Control: Git, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions